

Project Design Document (PDD)

Carbon Project Development Template

Template 1 of 5 · Version v1.0 · For course use and capstone project

HOW TO USE THIS TEMPLATE

Complete all sections below. Fields marked [REQUIRED] must be filled before submitting to a verification body. Fields marked [OPTIONAL] provide context that strengthens the project case. Delete instructional text (shown in italics) before final submission.

SECTION A: PROJECT IDENTIFICATION

A1. Project Title [REQUIRED]

Full name of the carbon project

A2. Project ID

Assigned by registry upon submission

A3. Project Version

e.g. v1.0

A4. Project Start Date

DD/MM/YYYY

A5. Crediting Period End Date

DD/MM/YYYY

A6. Implementing Organisation [REQUIRED]

Name, registration number, address

A7. Contact Person

Name, designation, email, phone

A8. Carbon Standard

Verra VCS / Gold Standard / Other

A9. Methodology

e.g. VM0042, VM0017

A10. Project Type [REQUIRED]

Biochar / Soil Carbon / Agroforestry / CCS / Other

SECTION B: PROJECT DESCRIPTION

B1. Project Summary [REQUIRED] (200–500 words)

Describe the project activity, location, scale, and expected climate impact

B2. Location [REQUIRED]

State, District, Village(s) / GPS coordinates of project boundary

B3. Project Area [REQUIRED]

Total area in hectares; describe land use / tenure

B4. Number of Beneficiaries

Total households, farmers, or community members participating

B5. Project Activities [REQUIRED]

List all specific activities: e.g. 'No-till adoption across 2,000 ha', 'Biochar production using TLUD kilns', 'Agroforestry planting at 150 trees/ha'

B6. Technology Description [REQUIRED]

Describe the specific technology or practice. Include equipment type, operational parameters, and basis for technology selection

SECTION C: BASELINE AND ADDITIONALITY

C1. Baseline Scenario [REQUIRED]

What would have happened without this project? Describe current practices, current emissions, current land use. Provide supporting evidence.

C2. Additionality Demonstration [REQUIRED]

Explain why the project is additional — why would it NOT happen in the absence of carbon finance? Address: financial barriers, common practice test, regulatory surplus test.

C3. Baseline Emissions Estimate

Estimated CO₂e emissions per year in the baseline scenario (tonne/year). Show calculation.

C4. Leakage Assessment

Identify potential leakage sources and quantify. E.g. if crop residue was previously used for animal bedding, the loss of that use must be accounted.

SECTION D: QUANTIFICATION AND MONITORING PLAN

D1. Quantification Method [REQUIRED]

Reference specific equations from the approved methodology. Show worked example for one monitoring unit.

D2. Monitoring Parameters [REQUIRED]

List all parameters to be monitored, measurement method, frequency, responsible party, and equipment.

D3. Data Management

How will monitoring data be recorded, stored, and backed up? Who has access? How long are records retained?

D4. Estimated Annual Emissions Reductions

Projected tCO₂e/year for each year of the crediting period. Provide low, central, and high estimates.

SECTION E: COMMUNITY AND ENVIRONMENTAL SAFEGUARDS

E1. Stakeholder Consultation [REQUIRED]

Describe consultation process: who was consulted, when, and how. Attach consultation records.

E2. Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)

For projects involving indigenous or tribal communities, describe FPIC process and attach consent documentation.

E3. Benefit Sharing Arrangement

How will carbon revenue be distributed? What % to farmers? What % to implementing organisation? What community benefits?

E4. Grievance Mechanism

How can community members raise complaints? Who handles them? What is the resolution timeline?

E5. Environmental Impact Assessment

Identify any negative environmental impacts. How will they be mitigated? Are any regulatory approvals required?

--

SECTION F: RISK ASSESSMENT

Risk Description	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Measure
Farmer dropout / practice reversion	H/M/L	H/M/L	
Drought or flood destroying carbon gains	H/M/L	H/M/L	
Methodology reversal / standard change	H/M/L	H/M/L	
Buyer default on offtake agreement	H/M/L	H/M/L	
Regulatory change affecting project	H/M/L	H/M/L	
Price collapse in voluntary carbon market	H/M/L	H/M/L	

SECTION G: DECLARATIONS AND SIGNATURES

Authorised Signatory (Project Developer)

Date

Name and Title

DD/MM/YYYY

--	--

Signature

--